

Save the Librarian

A librarian, Brooke Stacks, is in the stacks of the library putting away books at the Ed. U. Cation library on a ladder when all of the sudden Miss Information almost pushes her off into the void of falsehoods. The student researcher must save the librarian through the power of research through a series of puzzles. Archie Ives warns the student that they must navigate through the stacks to save the librarian. On the way there are pit stops preventing them from passing through. Ideally I would like the student to be able to walk through a very basic depiction of a library. However it may be more beneficial or affordable to have it just be a bunch of cut scenes.

Two student player options:

Girl: Paige Turner

Guy: Lyle Brary

Other character name ideas (all play on word names):

Paige Turner

Reid A. Booker

Callie N. UMBER

Cat A. Loge

Archie Ives

Nala Vel

Lyle Brary

Brook Stacks

Louis Leif

Maggie Zine

Circe U Lation

Rhett Ference

Manny Script

Drew Date

Perry O'Discolls

Essa Saez

Nara Tives

Ed U. Cation

John Rah

Bibi L. Graphy

Reba Serch

For each puzzle I want one of these names to be a librarian helping the student. Feel free to change the names as needed.

Puzzle #1: Forming a Thesis Statement.

Essa Saez: A thesis statement is the core problem or idea you will be exploring in your paper that forms the basis of the body of your research. What do we want to do for our thesis?

Option #1: Right option

How to save, Brooke Stacks, the librarian through the research process by creating keywords for the journal search, finding peer reviewed articles, developing the structure of the paper, parsing a quote, citing your sources, and finding the physical copy of the journal

Option #2: Wrong Option

How to help Nara Tives repair old books by gluing the binding back to the pages, reinforcing the tape, adding new labels, erasing pencil marks, and removing sticky notes.

Puzzle #2 Crafting Keywords

Rhett Ference: Now we must craft keywords to use when we search through the journal website to help us find articles to back up our argument or thesis statement. Use “ “ to group words together. You can also use AND or OR between keywords to change the result by either grouping keywords (using AND) or separating them (using OR).

Have a bunch of keywords scattered about to select the player passes when they choose the right keywords

Right keywords: “Brooke Stacks” , librarians, keywords, “peer reviewed”, filtering, “paper structure” “parsing a quote”, citation, “physical copies”

Wrong keywords:

Genre, Circulation, Cataloging, "Book Repair", Mystery, "Inter-library loan", Periodicals, Accessioning, Provenance, "Archie Ives"

Have it look like they are typing into an educational search engine like JSTOR or EBSCO Please ask if questions!

Puzzle #3: Finding Peer Reviewed Articles

Reba Search: There are two documents that look promising to support your argument. However, one is peer reviewed and one is not. To save the librarian, you must find the more credible source by determining if it is peer reviewed. The process of peer reviewing ensures that other researchers and scholars have read and conducted a fact finding process which proves the article is more credible.

The student must click on the 2 different documents and then click on the journal's website which explains that the article is double blind peer reviewed while the other one is not and has no information. The student will pass if they choose the peer reviewed option. (The writing in the document can just be scribbles, with the title being a relevant article like.....)

Puzzle #4 Develop the Structure of your paper

Nala Vel: It is important to craft the structure of your paper to determine what your research process will look like. Place the items in the order of the typical research structure. This is how you will order and organize your ideas. (Have a hint that pops up when they struggle that basically tells them how to order it

They will have to place the structures in the right order:

1. Introduction- An introduction basically includes your thesis statement and the "why" of your paper to inform the reader on what it will be about
2. Literature review - The literature review backs up the claims you made by including information from previous research
3. Methodology- The methodology section is the manner in which you go about conducting your own research
4. Results-The results section is the outcomes of your original research and contains the statistics and relevant qualitative and quantitative information you have gathered
5. Analysis-The analysis goes over your discoveries from your research and connects it to your broader thesis. It also shares how these findings are important.
6. Conclusion-Your conclusion is a way to wrap up your paper and summarize the entirety of the essay and your research in a way that neatly concludes your ideas
7. References-This is very important. Always, and I mean always, cite the ideas of others in the reference section. There are many different styles of references for you to choose, but be careful that it is in the correct formatting.

Puzzle #5 Parsing a Quote

Manny Script: Now you must take a quote from your article that backs up your thesis statement for your literature review. You already found one journal article so let's look closer and find a quote. Which quote best backs up your claim. While it is okay, and

even encouraged, to write about dissenting scholars in your work, we are looking for something that backs up your claim. We will use this quote in your paper! Reminder your thesis statement is: How to save, Brooke Stacks, the librarian through the research process by creating keywords for the journal search, finding peer reviewed articles and filtering, developing the structure of the paper, parsing a quote, citing your sources, and finding the physical copy of the journal

Right answer: "The study found that 95% of participants believed that the librarian could be saved through the power of research so long as the student answered the questions correctly"

Wrong answer: "The study found that 95% of participants believed that the librarian should allow Miss Information to trap them in the void."

Wrong answer #2: "The study found that 85% of participants believed that Nara Tives could repair the books in the library using only Gene Rah's superglue."

Puzzle # 6 Methodology

Which methodology would help back up your claims? Remember qualitative research is research that is about gathering thoughts, opinions or looking at behaviors while quantitative research is research founded in data, numbers, and graphs.

Right answer: A focus group, or a small group of interviewed individuals using qualitative research, to ask about what to do in depth to save the librarian

Wrong answer: A survey which gathers quantitative evidence by asking questions about which graphic novel Drew Date likes best

Wrong answer: An observation, or a period of time where participants are watched to understand behavior, of patrons at the Ed. U Cation library and how they interact with the librarians

Puzzle #7 Citing your Sources

John Rah: It is vital to cite your sources in the last part of your paper titled "References." There the student will have complete documentation of the origins of their sources cited within the text of the paper. This is important because it proves that the paper has credibility and avoids the chances of potential plagiarism. You might have heard of MLA, APA, or Chicago as these are the most popular types of citations. Since we don't know which one you will be using let's gather some information that might be useful for the development of a citation

Show a document and have them find the: author, date, title of the work, the journal name, the volume and issue number, the DOI or website link.

APA format:

Graphy, B. L. (2026). Empirical analysis of the saving of librarians through the power of research. *The Journal of Librarianship* 1(1). <https://doi.org/.....>

Now you have created your own citation.

Puzzle #8 Bonus: Finding a Physical Journal

Perry O'Discolls: In some cases the library will have a physical copy of your journal. Yipee! In this case you must find the journal out in the stacks that contains the individual article. Oftentimes the library will use the Library of Congress call number to help you search for it. Callie N. Umber has given you a key. Brooke Stacks is located in the area where the journals about library science are. Please check the library of congress's webpage to learn more about how to search for books. For now, we only need you to find the general section.

There are a bunch of books out on the shelf and the player must match the sticky note to the book by identifying the right book.

Have a direction for up down right and left:

Correct:

Right

Z886

Incorrect:

Left

RT99

Up

HG2

Down

T55

Down

Key:

RT -RT120 = Nursing

HG1 – HG179= General Finance

Z671-Z1000= Library Science

T1 – T54: General Engineering

The player will now reach where Brooke Stacks is. She is falling and almost tipped off her ladder. When the student either catches her or just saves her. Miss Information is thwarted and runs off. That sure was weird. The student gets a certificate of completion and the final picture is of all of them celebrating. Credits roll.

Each of these puzzles are meant to be super easy and passable even if they initially failed. The point is to study gamification and what the student thinks of it and not to study how well they do on the game. It's more about what they think about having a game instead of reading the same information on a paper which might be less engaging.